

Did you know?

- Typeset is a US based SaaS (software-as-a-service) platform and also has an office in Bengaluru.
- typeset.io/pricing says the basic product is free. But if you exceed certain requirements — in terms of a number of words, or need plagiarism checks — then a monthly fee starts at US\$ 8 per month under the yearly plan.
- Typeset allows you to choose from over 100,000+ verified journal formats.
- You can upload your word-processed file and enhance publication chances, collaboration possibilities, or submit directly to your journal from Typeset.
- Journal guidelines do keep changing. Growth has been through word-of-mouth, with academic authors telling their colleagues about it.

Largest research authoring platform

So that's how this techie from India started getting noticed. At Typeset, he built what he describes as “the world's largest research authoring platform used by 1M+ researchers producing 30,000+ papers per month.... from 91 countries.”

Chandha backs Open Access as a route for effective academic publishing. He also supports Academic SEO actively. (Open Access encourages research to be distributed online, often free of cost or without other access barriers. Academic Search Engine Optimization, or ASEO, attempts to get academic articles found — or crawled — and widely indexed. Both make an impact on how widely an academic article can travel.)

They work with universities too, improving visibility of, and accessibility to, research content. “No-pay-wall is the way forward; that's what we believe,” he says, suggesting that Open Access helps readers to find the content they need, and scholars to get noticed due to their work. He reminds us that every research paper related to Covid-19 was made free-to-access for all during the pandemic.

Chandha has a Masters's degree in software engineering from the 1984-founded Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT), in northeast Tamil Nadu. He is also a Stanford University GSB Ignite alumni. He is based in San Francisco and Bengaluru.

Links

Typeset: <https://typeset.io/>

OJS Guides: <https://typeset.io/resources/tag/ojs/>

Open Journal Systems: <https://pkp.sfu.ca/ojs/>

Typeset claims offering 45,000 journal formats with 35,000 research documents published monthly.

The figure of so many journal formats is mind-boggling. How was this managed? “We have the largest template database in the market that we've built since 2016. We automated most of the processes involved in creating and maintaining templates. We also rely on the rules present in the publicly available LaTeX templates contributed by the community. Without the community contributions this would have taken much more time to build,” Chandha says.

OJS software and guides

Building awareness about the potential of the OJS is a priority, Chandha notes. The OJS software is so user friendly, that it makes it very simple for the articles to be submitted, peer-reviewed, edited, proof-read and indexed.

OJS software sets ‘roles’ that allow individuals to act as the

journal manager, editor, reviewer, author and reader. It also allows for subscription-based journals.

Once published in an OJS-run journal, an article gets easily indexed in places where it can be found effortlessly. OJS is written in PHP, and deploys MariaDB (formerly MySQL) or PostgreSQL for its database. It is translated into 17 languages (including Indonesian, Persian, Turkish and Arabic) but Hindi, Chinese and Vietnamese are ‘in development’.

Typeset has written three guides for this promising product, OJS. “There will be more. We've seen that a lot of users who use OJS, and who want to automate their process, have a lot of questions. Even though OJS itself has a guide, we've created a comprehensive one. We've done so after looking at questions coming up, interviewing journal editors about what kind of problems they've faced, and taking into consideration how we can communicate and educate the community better,” says Chandha.

He adds: “Next, we're working on a couple of interesting problems. Typeset is about creation workflow.”

He explains: “We are building a full stack workflow for researchers, with discovery, creation, collaboration and publishing built into one platform. It will help authors to discover papers faster, find collaborators quickly, write, self-publish, and also help institutions to improve their research output. We're already working with more than a dozen universities for this.”

Saikiran Chandha, CEO and founder of Typeset, says the firm can also support those in academia who want to format their own academic journal, or improve the visibility of an existing one. 

 By: Frederick Noronha

The author is an independent journalist and publisher, and has written on FOSS for almost two decades.